

9 Normative Ethics Background Quiz ANS

1. What is moral relativism, as defined in the deck?

- A) There is no objective standard of morality that applies to all people in all situations
- B) Morality can be derived only from the written laws that a particular society has
- C) Moral questions have no answers at all, because they are purely empirical matters
- D) One single moral code applies to everyone in every culture at every point in time

ANS: A) There is no objective standard of morality that applies to all people in all situations

2. Which of the following is an intrinsic good rather than an instrumental good?

- A) Love
- B) Money
- C) Career opportunities
- D) Power

ANS: A) Love

3. How does the deck define wellbeing as pleasure (hedonism)?

- A) Wellbeing is determined by a person's income and wealth
- B) Wellbeing is a set of objective goods such as knowledge
- C) Wellbeing is the satisfaction of whatever we desire
- D) The balance of pleasure over pain constitutes wellbeing

ANS: D) The balance of pleasure over pain constitutes wellbeing

4. Why does the deck say that revealed preferences can be more useful than stated preferences?

- A) People always say exactly what they prefer, so stated preferences are fully reliable
- B) Revealed preferences can never conflict with the stated preferences people report
- C) Stated preferences always change faster over time than revealed preferences do
- D) A revealed preference illustrates our actions, not our intentions

ANS: D) A revealed preference illustrates our actions, not our intentions

5. What is an informed preference?

- A) It is whatever someone happens to say that they prefer in casual conversation
- B) It is whatever someone happened to choose at some time in the distant past
- C) It considers all relevant information and can change as more is learned
- D) It is a preference that can never change over time, however much is learned

ANS: C) It considers all relevant information and can change as more is learned

6. What is meant by objective goods in the account of wellbeing?

- A) Things that are good because they maximize profit for the people who own them
- B) Things that are good independent of personal beliefs or opinions
- C) Things that are good only if a person happens to desire them at the time
- D) Things that are good because they give a particular person a great deal of pleasure

ANS: B) Things that are good independent of personal beliefs or opinions

7. What risk does the deck mention about AI chatbot companions that aim to maximize revealed preferences?

- A) They may addict us and leave us unhappy
- B) They may refuse to talk
- C) They may give us shallow but amusing content
- D) They may push us toward self-development goals we may not wish

ANS: A) They may addict us and leave us unhappy

8. What is the difference between constraints and obligations?

- A) Constraints require certain actions, while obligations prohibit certain actions
- B) Both are legal rules that have no moral significance
- C) Constraints prohibit certain actions, while obligations require certain actions
- D) Both are actions that are morally optional to perform

ANS: C) Constraints prohibit certain actions, while obligations require certain actions

9. What is the difference between positive and negative rights?

- A) Positive rights require others to abstain, while negative rights require others to act
- B) Both positive and negative rights require only abstention from others
- C) Positive rights require others to act, while negative rights require others to abstain
- D) Positive rights apply only to humans, while negative rights apply only to animals

ANS: C) Positive rights require others to act, while negative rights require others to abstain

10. What do impartial moral theories imply?

- A) We should value our friends and family more than strangers
- B) We should value individual lives equally
- C) We should ignore all rules
- D) We should value only our own life

ANS: B) We should value individual lives equally

11. Why do some philosophers, such as hedonists, argue that non-human animals should be included in the moral circle?

- A) Their ability to speak a human language
- B) Their ability to vote in elections
- C) Their capacity for suffering
- D) Their ability to sign legal contracts

ANS: C) Their capacity for suffering

12. How does the deck describe normative ethics?

- A) The study of the underlying concepts that make moral reasoning possible in the first place
- B) A description of how people actually behave in real situations that involve morality
- C) A set of empirical findings about which preferences people hold in practice
- D) Concrete moral standards and principles that govern how we ought to behave

ANS: D) Concrete moral standards and principles that govern how we ought to behave

13. According to utilitarianism, which action is right?

- A) The one that increases overall wellbeing the most, impartially and globally
- B) The one that best respects long-standing tradition and the customs of the community
- C) The one that follows a fixed rule, regardless of what its consequences turn out to be
- D) The one that benefits only the agent's own family and close friends the most

ANS: A) The one that increases overall wellbeing the most, impartially and globally

14. In the Drunk Driving example (probabilities 0.95 for getting home safely with utility +1 and 0.05 for a fatal accident with utility -1000), what is the expected utility of driving home?

- A) +0.95
- B) -49.05
- C) -49.5
- D) -1000

ANS: B) -49.05

15. What is the point of Nozick's Experience Machine as a critique of utilitarianism?

- A) It shows that people's preferences are always stable and consistent over long periods of time
- B) It proves that pleasure is the only thing that has any value for human beings
- C) It suggests utilitarianism over-emphasizes wellbeing, since most people would refuse to plug in
- D) It shows that everyone would gladly choose to plug in to the machine for life

ANS: C) It suggests utilitarianism over-emphasizes wellbeing, since most people would refuse to plug in

16. What is the demandingness objection to utilitarianism?

- A) Utilitarianism demands that people never calculate anything about the outcomes of their acts
- B) Utilitarianism prohibits all giving to charity by individuals, however wealthy they are
- C) Utilitarianism requires people to do only what is legal in the place where they live
- D) If our money helps others more than it helps us, utilitarianism offers no reason to keep it

ANS: D) If our money helps others more than it helps us, utilitarianism offers no reason to keep it

17. How does the utilitarian respond to the objection that it requires intractable reasoning?

- A) Calculation is always possible and perfectly precise in practice
- B) A theory's criterion of rightness need not match its decision procedure
- C) The theory cannot guide action at all, and utilitarians concede this
- D) There is no criterion of rightness for utilitarianism at all

ANS: B) A theory's criterion of rightness need not match its decision procedure

18. Which of the following is a key idea of deontology?

- A) Always maximize total wellbeing across every one of the people who are affected
- B) Focus on constraints and obligations rather than the best outcome, protecting human autonomy
- C) Judge every single action only by the quality of its consequences for everyone
- D) Treat all moral rules as entirely optional whenever they become inconvenient to follow

ANS: B) Focus on constraints and obligations rather than the best outcome, protecting human autonomy

19. According to the Doctrine of Double Effect, when is an agent morally allowed to carry out an action that predictably leads to a bad outcome?

- A) Never, regardless of what the agent's intentions happen to be at the time
- B) When the agent intends the bad effect as a means of bringing about the good one
- C) Whenever the bad effect happens to be relatively small compared to the good effect
- D) When the agent intends the good effect but not the bad effect

ANS: D) When the agent intends the good effect but not the bad effect

20. What difficulty does the deck raise for threshold deontology (deferring to consequences when enough lives are at stake)?

- A) There is no clear, non-arbitrary way to say how many lives are "enough"
- B) It never defers to consequences, however many lives happen to be at stake
- C) It always gives exactly the same verdicts as utilitarianism in every possible case
- D) It rejects every constraint, including those on keeping promises and on honesty

ANS: A) There is no clear, non-arbitrary way to say how many lives are "enough"